D Mich 1 Grammar notes

Adjectives

- Adjectives describe/qualify nouns and nearly always* agree with the noun to which they refer.
- Some adjectives follow a pattern in how they become feminine or plural, others are completely irregular. Revise them.
- The majority of adjectives go after the noun they describe/qualify, but a small group of very common adjectives come before the noun. Some adjectives change their meaning according to whether they come before or after. See F Mich 9.
- * See F Mich 9 to learn about some adjectives that never agree and E Mich 1 to revise where the adjectives that don't agree when used as adverbs.

les filles intelligentes	*la semaine dernière*	*son dernier film*
un bel acteur	*un beau monsieur*	*une femme folle*
deux matchs amicaux	*une serviette sèche*	*elle pèse lourd*

Adverbs

- Unlike ADJECTIVES, **ADVERBS never agree**. Their form never changes. Instead of describing/qualifying things, **they describe/qualify VERBS**.
- ADJECTIVES **ending in a vowel**: *vrai, absolu – vraiment, absolument*
  - add –MENT to the **masculine** form
- most ADJECTIVES **ending in a consonant**: *lent, heureux – lentement, heureusement*
  - add –MENT to the **feminine** form
- ADJECTIVES ending –**ANT**/-**ENT**: *constant, évident – constamment, évidemment*
  - -remove –ANT/-ENT and replace with –**AMMENT**/-**EMMENT**
- IMPORTANT **EXCEPTIONS** TO MEMORISE:
  - gentil-**gentiment** bref-**brièvement** énorme-**énormément**
  - bon-**bien** mauvais-**mal** précis-**précisément**

- **Sometimes in French, adjectives may be used with certain verbs but they have an adverbial meaning.** These adjectives never agree, as they behave as if they were adverbs.
  - *Cette voiture a coûté très cher.* *La valise pèse lourd*

- **ADVERBS never come before subject and the verb** as is sometimes the case in English. "*I often go to Paris*" "~~*Je souvent vais à Paris*~~". **ADVERBS normally go after a CONJUGATED VERB or before an INFINITIVE.**

- **Some adjectives do not have an adverbial form**. They are translated by an adverbial phrase, such as "parler fort" = to speak loudly, in a loud voice.

- See E Mich 1.

Making comparisons

- **Simply add a comparative word such as "PLUS" in front of the adjective.**
  - *plus intéressant* *moins petit*

- The adjective goes in its usual place, and agrees as usual
  - *un livre plus intéressant* *une plus petite fille*

- See page 24 of the F pamphlet for a revision of the basics.

- So far you have learned about comparing adjectives. Note also the following points when comparing nouns and infinitives.

- When **comparing nouns**, the partitive article "du, de la or des" becomes "**de**", and to say "as many/much as" you use "**autant de...que (de)**". Definite articles (le, la, les) remain unchanged.

  - *Ils ont plus de livres que de DVDs (ils ont DES livres et DES DVDs)*
  - *Elle a moins d'argent que moi (elle a DE L'argent)*
  - *Il a autant de CDs que de DVD, mais pas autant d'amis que moi*
  - *J'aime autant les pommes que les poires.*

- When **comparing infinitives**, if the conjugated verb takes a preposition before the next infinitive, this preposition is repeated before the word "que". If there is no preposition, add "de" before the que:

  - *Il pense plus à s'amuser **qu'à** travailler (penser à faire qc)*
  - *Nous avons autant besoin de manger **que de** dormir (avoir besoin de faire qc)*
  - *Je préfère faire des révisions **que d**'échouer à mon examen (préférer faire qc)*